Good-Bye, Mr. Chips — Class 12 (PCTB, English Medium)

Solved Exercises | James Hilton | Punjab Curriculum and Textbook Board

EXTENDED EDITION — The book contains no end-of-chapter question sets. Its only question set is the end-of-book EXERCISES (book p. 50), solved here in full (13 questions; Q. 13 has 6 brief notes). Earlier comprehension selections (Chapters 1-18) are retained.

Chapter 1: Chips at Brookfield

Comprehension questions

Who was Mr. Chips? Where did he teach?

Mr. Chips, whose real name was Arthur Chipping, was a schoolmaster.

He taught Latin and Greek at Brookfield, an English public school.

He joined Brookfield in 1870 as a young man of twenty-two.

He remained connected with the school for the rest of his long life.

Why was Chips called 'Mr. Chips'?

The boys shortened his name 'Chipping' to 'Chips' as a nickname.

At first it was used teasingly, but later it became a title of affection.

Old boys, colleagues and even the Head called him Chips.

The name stuck to him for more than sixty years.

What kind of teacher was Chips in his early years?

In his early years Chips was a strict but dull teacher.

He taught by old methods and the boys played tricks on him.

He was shy and lacked confidence in dealing with boys.

Yet he was kind at heart, and the boys gradually grew fond of him.

Chapter 2: Chips and the Boys

Comprehension questions

How did the boys treat Chips at first?

At first the boys treated Chips as a figure of fun.

They gave him nicknames and played pranks in his class.

They imitated his walk and his way of speaking.

Chips bore it patiently and never lost his temper.

How did Chips win the boys' respect?

Chips won respect by his fairness, kindness and sense of humour.

He never punished unjustly and remembered every boy's name.

He took interest in their games and their troubles.

Slowly the boys realised that behind the funny exterior was a good man.

What was Chips' attitude toward discipline?

Chips believed in firm but gentle discipline.

He did not rely on harsh punishment to control boys.

His quiet authority and personal example kept order.

Boys obeyed him because they respected and loved him.

Chapter 3: Katherine

Comprehension questions

Who was Katherine? How did Chips meet her?

Katherine Bridges was a young woman of twenty-five whom Chips met on a holiday.

He met her on a walking tour in the Lake District.

She was lively, charming and full of modern ideas.

Their meeting changed Chips' life completely.

How did Katherine change Chips?

Katherine taught Chips to be less shy and more cheerful.

She made him laugh, dress better and take interest in new ideas.

She softened his old-fashioned manners without spoiling his goodness.

Under her influence, Chips became a warmer and happier teacher.

What did Katherine think of Brookfield?

Katherine loved Brookfield and took interest in its life.

She attended school functions and made friends with the boys.

She admired Chips' devotion to the school.

The boys adored her and called her charming and kind.

Chapter 4: Marriage and Happiness

Comprehension questions

What was the effect of Chips' marriage on his teaching?

After marriage, Chips became a better and more popular teacher.

His classes became lively because Katherine's spirit entered them.

He began to understand boys better and to enjoy school life.

His marriage was the happiest period of his life.

How did Katherine die?

Katherine died in childbirth, along with her baby.

Her death was a terrible blow to Chips.

He was left alone after a very short married life.

He bore the loss bravely and returned to his work at Brookfield.

How did Chips keep Katherine's memory alive?

Chips never remarried and kept Katherine's memory in his heart.

He often thought of her advice and her laughter.

Her influence remained in his teaching for the rest of his life.

He felt that she was still with him in spirit.

Chapter 5: Chips the Housemaster

Comprehension questions

What new responsibility did Chips receive?

Chips was made a housemaster at Brookfield.

He took charge of a house of boys and looked after their welfare.

He managed their studies, games and discipline.

He proved to be a kind and understanding housemaster.

How did Chips deal with new boys?

Chips welcomed new boys warmly and put them at ease.

He remembered their names and their families.

He helped them settle down in the strange new school.

Many old boys remembered his kindness all their lives.

Why did boys love Chips as housemaster?

Boys loved him because he treated them as individuals.

He listened to their problems and gave wise advice.

He was strict when needed but never unkind.

His house became like a family under his care.

Chapter 6: The Passing Years

Comprehension questions

How did Brookfield change over the years?

Brookfield changed as new Heads, masters and boys came and went.

New buildings were added and new methods were introduced.

But the spirit of the school remained the same.

Chips watched these changes with interest and amusement.

What remained unchanged in Chips?

Chips remained devoted to Brookfield and to his boys.

His old jokes, his mannerisms and his kindness never changed.

He still wore his old gown and taught in his old way.

He became a living tradition of the school.

How did old boys remember Chips?

Old boys remembered Chips with love and gratitude.

They visited him when they returned to Brookfield.

They sent their sons to his house and to his classes.

For them, Chips was Brookfield itself.

Chapter 7: Chips and the Head

Comprehension questions

What was Chips' relation with the Heads of Brookfield?

Chips served under several Heads during his long career.

He respected them but was not afraid to speak his mind.

Some Heads valued him, while others thought him old-fashioned.

In the end, every Head recognised his worth to the school.

Why did some people think Chips was old-fashioned?

Chips used old teaching methods and disliked unnecessary changes.

He believed in Latin, discipline and tradition.

Younger masters thought his methods were out of date.

But his results proved that character matters more than methods.

How did Chips defend tradition?

Chips defended tradition because it gave the school its character.

He believed new ideas should be tested before being adopted.

He was not against all change, only against hasty change.

His wisdom often proved right in the long run.

Chapter 8: The Boer War Period

Comprehension questions

How did the Boer War affect Brookfield?

The Boer War took many old boys to South Africa as soldiers.

The school followed their news with pride and anxiety.

Some old boys were killed, and their names were honoured.

The war brought a new seriousness to school life.

How did Chips react to the war news?

Chips read the names of old boys in the newspapers with emotion.

He felt proud of their courage and sad at their deaths.

He spoke to the boys about duty and sacrifice.

The war deepened his love for his old pupils.

What lesson does this part of the novel teach?

It teaches that a teacher's influence lasts beyond school.

Old boys carry their school's values into the world.

Chips' pride in them shows the bond between teacher and pupil.

True education is measured by character, not by examinations.

Chapter 9: Chips Becomes Headmaster

Comprehension questions

How did Chips become Headmaster of Brookfield?

When the Headmaster fell ill, Chips was asked to act in his place.

Later he was appointed Headmaster of Brookfield.

It was a great honour for a man who had served the school so long.

He accepted it with humility and a sense of duty.

Was Chips successful as Headmaster?

Chips was not a great administrator, but he was loved by all.

He ran the school with kindness and common sense.

He avoided quarrels and kept the school united.

His headmastership was remembered for its human touch.

Why did Chips retire from the headmastership?

Chips retired because of his advancing age and weak health.

He felt that a younger man should lead the school.

He stepped down gracefully without bitterness.

He continued to live near the school and to visit it often.

Chapter 10: Retirement

Comprehension questions

Where did Chips live after retirement?

After retirement, Chips lived in a small house across the road from Brookfield.

From his window he could see the school chapel and playing fields.

Old boys and masters visited him there regularly.

He remained a part of Brookfield even in retirement.

How did Chips spend his retired life?

Chips spent his time reading, remembering and receiving visitors.

He followed school news and kept in touch with old boys.

He told stories of the past to young visitors.

His house became a place of pilgrimage for Brookfield men.

Did retirement make Chips unhappy?

No, Chips was content in retirement.

He felt his life's work was done and well done.

The love of old boys comforted him in his old age.

He looked back on his career with satisfaction and gratitude.

Chapter 11: The First World War

Comprehension questions

How did the First World War affect Brookfield?

The First World War took hundreds of Brookfield boys to the front.

Many were killed, and the school mourned them deeply.

Masters also left to serve, and the school was short-staffed.

The war years were the saddest in Brookfield's history.

How did Chips help during the war?

Chips, though old, came back to help the school in wartime.

He took classes and encouraged the boys and masters.

He read out the names of the fallen with honour.

His presence gave courage to the whole school.

What was Chips' attitude toward the war?

Chips hated war but honoured the courage of those who fought.

He believed that the boys died for duty and for their country.

He never glorified war, but he respected sacrifice.

His sermons on the fallen moved the whole school.

Chapter 12: Chips and the New Head

Comprehension questions

How did Chips get on with the new Headmaster?

The new Head was young and full of modern ideas.

At first he and Chips did not understand each other.

But the Head soon recognised Chips' wisdom and worth.

They became friends and worked together for the school.

What did the new Head learn from Chips?

He learned that tradition and human values matter in a school.

He learned to know the boys as individuals, not as numbers.

He learned that discipline comes from love, not from fear.

Chips' example softened his strict modern methods.

Why is this chapter important in the novel?

It shows the meeting of the old and the new in education.

It proves that age and experience deserve respect.

It shows Chips' greatness in his humility and wisdom.

The chapter prepares the reader for Chips' peaceful end.

Chapter 13: Old Age

Comprehension questions

How did old age affect Chips?

Old age made Chips weak in body but clear in mind.

He walked slowly and his hearing grew poor.

But his memory of boys and events remained sharp.

He faced old age with humour and patience.

What were Chips' feelings about his long life?

Chips felt grateful for his long and useful life.

He believed he had done his duty as a teacher.

He regretted only that he had no children of his own.

But he felt that thousands of boys were his children.

How did visitors treat old Chips?

Visitors treated him with love and reverence.

Old boys brought their sons to meet him.

They listened to his stories with delight.

For them, meeting Chips was like meeting Brookfield's history.

Chapter 14: The Last Days

Comprehension questions

How did Chips spend his last days?

Chips spent his last days in his house near Brookfield.

He was often in bed, but his mind remained active.

Friends and old boys visited him and cheered him.

He talked of the past and of Katherine with affection.

What did Chips say about his children?

Someone said it was a pity Chips had no children.

Chips replied that he had thousands of children.

He meant the boys he had taught over sixty years.

They were all his children, and he was proud of them.

What is the meaning of Chips' famous remark?

The remark means that a teacher lives on in his pupils.

Chips had no son of his own, but his influence lived in thousands.

It is the finest tribute to a teacher's life.

It sums up the whole message of the novel.

Chapter 15: The Death of Chips

Comprehension questions

How did Chips die?

Chips died peacefully in his sleep in November 1933.

He had lived through the reigns of five kings and two wars.

His death was mourned by the whole of Brookfield.

Old boys from all over the world sent messages of grief.

What was the reaction of Brookfield to his death?

Brookfield felt it had lost its soul and its memory.

The chapel bell tolled and the school stood in silence.

Masters and boys felt they had lost a father.

His funeral was attended by generations of Brookfield men.

What legacy did Chips leave behind?

Chips left no wealth, only the memory of a good life.

He left the example of kindness, humour and duty.

He left thousands of pupils who loved and honoured him.

His name became a legend at Brookfield.

Chapter 16: Good-Bye, Mr. Chips — The Title

Comprehension questions

Why is the novel called 'Good-Bye, Mr. Chips'?

The title is the farewell of generations of boys to their teacher.

It expresses love, gratitude and sorrow at parting.

Chips said goodbye to Brookfield many times, and finally forever.

The title captures the affectionate farewell of the whole novel.

What is the theme of the novel?

The theme is the life of a simple, devoted schoolmaster.

It shows how a teacher shapes the lives of thousands.

It shows that greatness lies in goodness, not in fame.

It celebrates the quiet heroism of ordinary duty.

Why is Mr. Chips an unforgettable character?

Chips is unforgettable because he is human and real.

He is funny, shy, kind and wise by turns.

Readers see him grow from a nervous young man to a beloved old master.

His love for boys and for Brookfield makes him immortal.

Chapter 17: Characters in the Novel

Comprehension questions

Describe the character of Mr. Chips.

Chips was kind, humorous, patient and devoted to duty.

He was shy and old-fashioned, but wise and understanding.

He loved his boys and remembered them all their lives.

His character is a model of a good teacher.

Describe the character of Katherine.

Katherine was young, lively, charming and modern.

She loved Chips and changed his life for the better.

She was kind to the boys and popular at Brookfield.

Her early death left a lasting sorrow in Chips' life.

Who are the other important characters?

The Heads of Brookfield, like Ralston, play important roles.

Old boys like Colley and others represent generations of pupils.

The masters and matrons form the background of school life.

Together they create the world of Brookfield.

Chapter 18: Review of the Novel

Comprehension questions

What does the novel teach about teaching?

It teaches that teaching is not only giving knowledge.

It is shaping character and winning hearts.

A teacher who loves his pupils succeeds even with old methods.

The true reward of teaching is the love of pupils.

What does the novel teach about life?

It teaches that a quiet life of duty can be a great life.

Fame and wealth are not necessary for happiness.

Love, humour and service make life meaningful.

Chips' life proves that ordinary people can be heroes.

Why is 'Good-Bye, Mr. Chips' popular in Pakistan?

It is popular because its theme is universal.

Pakistani students love its humour and its human story.

It teaches respect for teachers, a value dear in Pakistan.

It has been read by generations of students with delight.

Book Exercises — End of Book (verbatim, complete)

Book exercise — EXERCISES, book p. 50 (verbatim, complete)

1. Write a note on Brookfield.

Brookfield was an old English public school, founded in the reign of Queen Elizabeth as a grammar school.

It stood in beautiful fenland country, surrounded by ancient elms, with open countryside and plenty of playing grounds.

Its main building was rebuilt in the reign of King George I, and under Mr. Wetherby in the mid-nineties it recovered much of its old glory.

It never ranked with Eton or Harrow, but it was a good school of the second rank,

proud of its traditions.

2. What contribution did Brookfield make to England?

Brookfield produced judges, professional men, Members of Parliament, colonial administrators, peers and bishops.

It also turned out merchants, manufacturers, country squires and parsons who served England in every walk of life.

When the First World War broke out in 1914, many of its teachers and boys joined the Armed Forces and many died for England.

Its grounds were used for training, so that in peace and in war Brookfield contributed to the glory of England.

3. Draw a character sketch of Mr. Chips.

Mr. Chips, whose real name was Arthur Chipping, was born in 1848 and joined Brookfield in 1870 at the age of twenty-two.

He was a Cambridge graduate, handsome and impressive as a young man, but shy, and at first a strict and rather dull teacher.

He was not a profound scholar of Greek and Latin, though he liked to use Latin phrases as tags in his conversation.

Over sixty years he grew into a wise, kindly and humorous master, loved by generations of boys, and at last looked upon as an institution.

4. Write a note on Mr. Chips as a teacher.

Chips taught Latin and Greek at Brookfield for more than sixty years, from 1870 until his retirement and beyond.

In his early years he taught by old methods, and the boys played tricks on him, but he bore them patiently and never lost his temper.

He won respect by fairness and kindness, by remembering every boy's name and face, and by taking interest in their games and troubles.

His discipline was firm but gentle, and his quiet authority, humour and personal

example kept order better than harsh punishment.

5. Write an account of Mr. Chips' married life.

Chips met Katherine Bridges on a walking holiday in the Lake District, when he was forty-eight and she was twenty-five.

After a short courtship they married, and Chips enjoyed nearly two years of idyllic married life, the happiest time of his life.

Katherine made a new man of him: his discipline improved, his humour bloomed into richness, and he became gentle, wise and popular.

Her life was cut short by childbirth, and the child also died; Chips never married again, and Katherine's memory stayed with him for the rest of his life.

6. What influence did Katherine Bridges exercise on Mr. Chips?

Katherine softened Chips' shyness and made him cheerful, better dressed and open to new ideas.

She brought advanced, radical views, learned from Ibsen, Bernard Shaw and William Morris, and shared them with him in friendly argument.

She drew him into school life beyond the classroom: matches, social gatherings and music concerts, where she herself was a fine musician.

Her influence broadened his outlook, improved his teaching and discipline, and turned a dull old bachelor into a warm, popular master.

7. Describe the first encounter between Mr. Chips and Katherine Bridges.

Chips met Katherine Bridges during a walking tour in the Lake District, when he was on holiday from Brookfield.

He wrenched his ankle in a useless effort to help her, and she attended him during his illness with great kindness.

She was twenty-five, a governess out of a job, who rode a bicycle and held advanced views very different from his own.

In spite of the difference in age and ideas, they fell in love and married, and the

meeting changed Chips' whole life.

8. Describe the quarrel between Ralston and Chips.

Mr. Ralston was a young, energetic and modernising Headmaster who thought Chips old-fashioned and out of date.

He pressed Chips to retire, believing that the school needed younger men and newer methods, and he spoke of Chips as a joke.

Chips stood his ground and refused to be driven out, defending tradition and his long service to the school.

In the end Ralston left Brookfield, while Chips remained, and the school recognised that age and experience deserved respect.

9. Write a note on Mr. Chips' humour.

Chips' humour was quaint and gentle, without any malice, and it grew richer as the years passed.

He joked with Latin tags, puns and his famous 'umph', and the boys laughed with him, never cruelly at him.

His remarks became legends at Brookfield, like his answer to Lloyd George and his memory of Colley and the 'Ablative Absolute'.

His humour endeared him to boys and public alike, and it was one reason why everyone came to look upon him as an institution.

10. Can we look upon Mr. Chips as an institution of Brookfield?

Yes, Mr. Chips can truly be called an institution of Brookfield, because he served the school for more than sixty years.

He taught fathers, sons and even grandsons, and he remembered them all, so that the whole history of the school lived in his memory.

Boys, masters, old boys and visitors all treated him as Brookfield itself, and his room, his jokes and his sayings belonged to the school.

As the book's own notes say, everyone came to look upon him as an institution, and

his death left Brookfield feeling that it had lost its soul.

11. Draw a character sketch of Katherine Bridges.

Katherine Bridges was twenty-five when she met Mr. Chips, and she was exceedingly beautiful.

She was a governess out of a job, who rode a bicycle, which was not much liked by the men of Victorian times.

She held advanced and radical ideas, learned from Ibsen, Bernard Shaw and William Morris, and she could be called a radical socialist.

She was more intelligent and brainy than Chips, became very popular at Brookfield, and her life was cut short by childbirth.

12. Write a short note on views and ideas of Katherine Bridges.

Katherine believed in modern, progressive ideas and in freedom from stiff Victorian conventions.

She admired Ibsen, Bernard Shaw and William Morris, and she held radical, even socialist, views on society and education.

She thought education should be broad and human, and she encouraged Chips to take interest in games, music and social life.

She put her ideas into practice at Brookfield, where she shared in matches, concerts and gatherings, and she won the love of boys and masters alike.

13(a). Write a brief note on Mr. Wetherby.

Mr. Wetherby was one of the early Heads of Brookfield in Chips' time, an old man when Chips joined the school.

He observed that Brookfield was an old Elizabethan foundation, and under him in the mid-nineties the school recovered most of its glory.

Chips remembered Brookfield in Wetherby's time, and Wetherby's long headship belonged to the school's older, quieter days.

He represents the traditional Brookfield that Chips himself served and loved.

13(b). Write a brief note on Mr. Meldrum.

Mr. Meldrum was a Headmaster of Brookfield who followed Mr. Wetherby in the school's history.

He belonged to the line of Heads under whom Chips served during his long career at the school.

Like the other Heads, he presided over Brookfield while Chips quietly taught Latin and Greek and grew in the boys' affection.

His headship forms part of the background of steady school life against which Chips' character develops.

13(c). Write a brief note on Mr. Ralston.

Mr. Ralston was a young, ambitious Headmaster who wanted to modernise Brookfield and sweep away its old ways.

He regarded Chips as old-fashioned, pressed him to retire, and quarrelled with him over tradition and discipline.

Chips refused to give way, and the quarrel ended with Ralston leaving Brookfield while Chips stayed on.

Ralston stands for hasty modernisation, against which the novel sets Chips' wisdom and love of tradition.

13(d). Write a brief note on Mr. Chatteris.

Mr. Chatteris was a kind and friendly Headmaster of Brookfield, and a friend of Chips.

When he fell ill and died during the First World War years, Chips was asked to take his place and help the school.

Chips' service as acting Head in wartime, reading out the names of the fallen, belongs to the Chatteris period.

He is remembered as a humane Head whose death brought Chips back into the full life of the school.

13(e). Write a brief note on Mr. Merivale.

Mr. Merivale was the Brookfield doctor and a close friend of old Chips.

He called every fortnight or so, sipped a glass of sherry, and assured Chips that he was fitter than himself.

He said Chips was past the age of horrible diseases and would die a really natural death, if he died at all.

Yet he sometimes whispered to Mrs. Wickett to look after Chips, because his chest put a strain on his heart.

13(f). Write a brief note on Mrs. Wickett.

Mrs. Wickett was Chips' landlady, who kept house for him just across the road from Brookfield.

After Chips gave up his mastership, he lived at her house for more than a decade, and she looked after him in his old age.

Chips would call out to her in his jerky, high-pitched voice to bring him a cup of tea before prep.

She cared for him faithfully, and Merivale trusted her to watch over Chips' health in his last years.